Unit 2: Connections

Connections: Reading – The importance of languages

Lesson 2-1
Book pages 25-27

💡 **Big idea:** The writer grew up in **Canada**, which has two official languages, English and French. At first French was not important to him, but a trip to France and his classmates' stories showed him that **language is part of culture**, and that we must stop languages from **dying out**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read for the main point and meaning
- Answer multiple-choice questions on short and long texts
- Learn words from the article
- Discuss whether the world needs one language

📖 Key words

official language لغة رسمية	**die out** ينقرض / يختفي	**culture** ثقافة	**realise** يُدرك
ancient قديم	**survive** يبقى / ينجو	**original** أصلي	**at risk** في خطر
protect يحمي	**community** مجتمع		

The article

- The writer saw French on signs and TV in Canada but felt it wasn't useful
- In middle school, a trip to France changed his mind: his French skills were useful to communicate with local teenagers
- He realised that language isn't just about words, it is about **culture**
- Many original languages of Canada, such as Cree, Ojibwe and Inuktitut, are at risk

Facts about languages

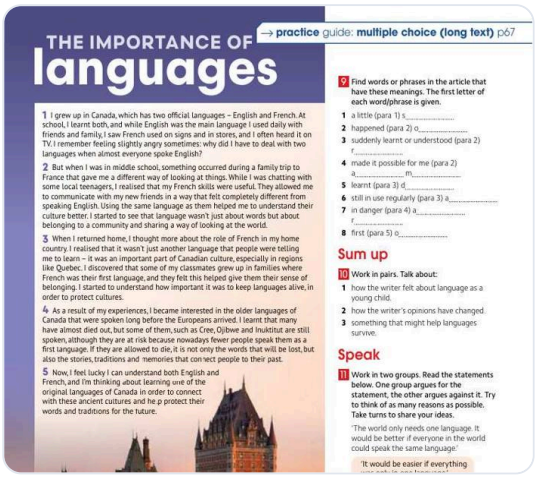
- Arabic is spoken by more than 300 million people
- There are still over 7,000 spoken languages in the world
- Some languages are dying out
- Speaking more than one language helps your brain

Study tip: multiple choice (long text)

- The last question tests your understanding of the **main point** of the text
- Read the whole text first, then each question carefully
- Find the part of the text that gives the answer

Speaking: one language or many?

- For: The world only needs one language. It would be easier if everyone spoke the same language.
- Against: Different languages make the world much more interesting.



THE IMPORTANCE OF languages

→ practice guide: multiple choice (long text) p67

1 I grew up in Canada, which has two official languages – English and French. At school, I learnt both, and while English was the main language I used daily with friends and family, I saw French used on signs and in stores, and I often heard it on TV. I remember feeling slightly angry sometimes: why did I have to deal with two languages when almost everyone spoke English?

2 But when I was in middle school, something occurred during a family trip to France that gave me a different way of looking at things. While I was chatting with some local teenagers, I realised that my French skills were useful. They allowed me to communicate with my new friends in a way that felt completely different from speaking English. Using the same language as them helped me to understand their culture better. I started to see that language wasn't just about words but about belonging to a community and sharing a way of looking at the world.

3 When I returned home, I thought more about the role of French in my home country. I realised that it wasn't just another language that people were telling me to learn – it was an important part of Canadian culture, especially in regions like Quebec. I discovered that some of my classmates grew up in families where French was their first language, and they felt this helped give them their sense of belonging. I started to understand how important it was to keep languages alive, in order to protect cultures.

4 As a result of my experiences, I became interested in the older languages of Canada that were spoken long before the Europeans arrived. I learnt that many have almost died out, but some of them, such as Cree, Ojibwe and Inuktitut are still spoken, although they are at risk because nowadays fewer people speak them as a first language. If they are allowed to die, it is not only the words that will be lost, but also the stories, traditions and memories that connect people to their past.

5 Now, I feel lucky I can understand both English and French, and I'm thinking about learning one of the original languages of Canada in order to connect with these ancient cultures and help protect their words and traditions for the future.

9 Find words or phrases in the article that have these meanings. The first letter of each word/phrase is given.

1 a little (para 1) s_____
2 happened (para 2) o_____
3 suddenly learnt or understood (para 2) r_____
4 made it possible for me (para 2) a_____ m_____
5 learnt (para 3) d_____
6 still in use regularly (para 3) a_____
7 in danger (para 4) a_____ r_____
8 first (para 5) o_____

Sum up

10 Work in pairs. Talk about:

1 how the writer felt about language as a young child.
2 how the writer's opinions have changed.
3 something that might help languages survive.

Speak

11 Work in two groups. Read the statements below. One group argues for the statement, the other argues against it. Try to think of as many reasons as possible. Take turns to share your ideas.

'The world only needs one language. It would be better if everyone in the world could speak the same language.'

'It would be easier if everything

The importance of languages (article)

✏️ Examples

How did the writer feel about learning French when he was young?

Answer: He didn't think it was necessary.

What does die out mean?

Answer: to disappear completely

⭐ Remember

- Look at the title and photos first to predict the topic.
- Arabic is one of the most spoken languages in the world: be proud of it!

⚠️ Watch out

- Choosing an answer because it repeats words from the text. The correct answer has the same meaning, not the same words.

🧩 **Activity:** Debate in two groups: The world only needs one language

✅ Check yourself

1. How many official languages does Canada have?
2. How many spoken languages are there in the world?
3. What did the writer learn in France?

Answers: (1) two, English and French ، (2) over 7,000 ، (3) French was useful to communicate with people